

Digital accounts to close or memorialise after a death

Tick what applies. You do not need to find everything before you start, and you never need a password. Save photos and messages before closing anything, and close the email account last.

Before you close anything

- ☐ Keep the phone charged; do not wipe it
- ☐ Keep the phone number active for a few months (security codes)
- ☐ Save photos, messages and tributes first
- ☐ Check for a legacy contact (Apple, Facebook, Instagram, TikTok) or Google's Inactive Account Manager

Social media

- ☐ **Facebook** memorialise or remove
- ☐ **Instagram** separate request, even if linked
- ☐ **Threads** follows Instagram
- ☐ **X (Twitter)** deactivation only
- ☐ **TikTok** memorialise or delete; save the videos first
- ☐ **LinkedIn** memorialise or close
- ☐ **Snapchat, Pinterest, Reddit, YouTube channel** support request
- ☐ Dating apps, forums, gaming communities

Email and the accounts that unlock everything

- ☐ **Email** Gmail, Outlook/Hotmail, Yahoo, the internet provider's address: close last
- ☐ **Google Account** Gmail, Photos, Drive, YouTube, Android
- ☐ **Apple Account** iCloud, backups, Activation Lock
- ☐ **Microsoft account** Outlook, OneDrive, Xbox, 365
- ☐ **Password manager** 1Password, LastPass, Bitwarden, browser

Messaging

- ☐ **WhatsApp** export chats; lapses after 120 days idle (365 in the US)
- ☐ **Messenger** handled with Facebook
- ☐ **Signal, Telegram, iMessage, WeChat, LINE, Viber**

Money and shopping

- ☐ **PayPal** balance is part of the estate
- ☐ **Venmo, Cash App, Wise, Revolut** check for a balance
- ☐ **Amazon** Prime, Kindle, Audible, Alexa, gift balance
- ☐ **eBay, Etsy, Marketplace, Poshmark, Kijiji, Gumtree** open sales, fees, balances
- ☐ **Apple and Google app subscriptions**
- ☐ **Banking, savings, investment and retirement apps** via the provider's bereavement team
- ☐ **Cryptocurrency** look for the wallet's recovery phrase
- ☐ **Loyalty points** airline miles, hotels, supermarket and pharmacy cards

Subscriptions that keep charging

- ☐ Netflix, Disney+, Prime Video, Apple TV+, Hulu, HBO Max, Crave, Stan
- ☐ Spotify, Apple Music, Audible, YouTube Premium
- ☐ iCloud+, Google One, Dropbox, OneDrive
- ☐ Microsoft 365, antivirus, VPN, fitness and dating apps
- ☐ Ring, Nest, alarm monitoring
- ☐ Newspapers, magazines, meal kits, delivery memberships

Phone, internet and TV

- ☐ **Cell phone or mobile plan** ask for the deceased customer team; keep the SIM active until done
- ☐ **Home internet and landline** and the email that came with it
- ☐ **Cable, satellite and streaming boxes** return the equipment

Devices, work and public accounts

- ☐ Phone, tablet, laptop, smartwatch, memory cards, drives
- ☐ Smart speakers and doorbells that still record
- ☐ PlayStation, Xbox, Nintendo, Steam
- ☐ **Website or domain name** expires, then someone else can register it
- ☐ **Blog, YouTube channel, podcast, Patreon, Substack, Etsy shop**
- ☐ Professional memberships, portfolio sites

The order to do it in

1. Stop the money: bank, PayPal, payment apps, phone plan, anything charging a relative's card
2. Secure what is public: memorialise or remove the social media profiles
3. Save what matters: photos, chats, devices
4. Close the rest, email last

The two documents you will need again and again: the death certificate, and a birth or marriage certificate or the court document appointing you (letters testamentary, grant of probate or letters of administration) that shows you can act. Nobody should ever ask for a password.